Andrew D. Crena

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EDUCATION

California State University, Chico - Chico, CA | B.A., Psychology *May 2022*

- Postgraduate coursework (non-degree): Psychology, University of Pittsburgh (2022–2023); Statistics, Community College of Allegheny County (2023).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Stanford University, Mind & Body Lab | PI: Dr. Alia Crum *June 2024 - Oct 2026*

Study Coordinator, EMBRACE Study (NCT06705218)

- Coordinated daily operations of a nationwide, fully decentralized NIH R01 RCT of a 10-week digital mindset intervention for newly diagnosed cancer patients: consent, scheduling, tracking, and retention for 444 participants across five timepoints.
- Built and tested the trial's REDCap instruments, monitored incoming data quality, and authored SOPs for recruitment, biospecimen collection, and participant tracking; assisted with IRB amendments and drafted sections of annual NIH progress reports (RPPR).
- Led community recruitment nationwide: partnered with cancer support and patient-advocacy organizations, co-developed participant-facing materials, and presented the study to patient communities.
- Managed at-home biomarker pipeline for 2,400+ Tasso-M20 dried blood spot kits (distribution, returns, processing, −80°C storage); co-developed the processing protocol under BSL-1 compliance and redesigned collection materials to reduce failed collections.
- Recruited, trained, and supervised ~20 undergraduate RAs to execute processing of blood samples, assist with our live participant communication system, and prepare blood kit materials

Lab Manager

- Supported launch of a doctoral researcher's yoga-based stress-mindset RCT for California bar-exam takers, built on the lab's decentralized platform: organized intervention materials and REDCap surveys, removed blood-collection components, and planned messaging around scheduled video releases.
- Developed a study-platform manual (written steps, screenshots, video walkthroughs) covering recruitment, intervention material, questionnaires, blood collection, and participant support, for our website framework to be used in future studies in the lab.
- Ran daily lab operations (onboarding, purchasing, reimbursements, events, visiting scholars, website) and served as EH&S liaison for biohazardous waste disposal and safety documentation.

ETH Zurich - *Zurich, Switzerland* *Aug 2026 – Present*

Affiliated Researcher, Interventions for Promoting Effective Uncertainty Regulation (SNSF grant no. 207691)

- Contribute to design decisions on intervention delivery and timing for a multi-arm online RCT of brief digital well-being interventions, and help develop its digitally delivered breathwork condition.
- Developed a guided cyclic-sighing breathwork video for a study intervention arm, designing visuals, producing audio, and integrating narration with timed breathing cues

Yaden Lab, Johns Hopkins University *Aug 2026 – Present*

Volunteer Archivist, Archive Project

- Identify new sources and catalog first-hand accounts of psychedelic, religious, spiritual, and mystical experiences for a digital research archive; attend weekly volunteer meetings (account review, literature discussion, visiting presenters).

San Diego State University TEND Lab | PI: Dr. Jillian Wiggins *May 2023 – May 2024*

Research Assistant (Post-Baccalaureate) - Volunteer, 20 hrs/week

- Supported data collection for a longitudinal NIMH R01 fMRI study of irritability in children ages 5–8 (mock scans, caregiver consent, basic clinical assessments, behavioral video recording); ran task stimuli during ~150 fMRI sessions alongside the scanner operator.

- Quality-checked fMRI data in AFNI (Linux, MATLAB) for motion and possible task-comprehension problems, logged results by session and scan, and trained other RAs in the procedure; cleaned data and charted study-completion progress in R.

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Pittsburgh Medical Center, DLAR *May 2022 – Apr 2023*

Laboratory Technician I - Full-time

- Provided husbandry, documented daily health observations, and delivered protocol-required treatments for research animals, primarily mice; oversaw breeding and weaning of immunocompromised and biohazardous strains

Crestwood Behavioral Health *May 2023 – Apr 2024*

Recovery Coach - San Diego, CA - Full-time

- Supported adults with co-occurring mental illness (including schizophrenia) and substance use in a transitional residential program for clients leaving conservatorship: one-on-one recovery-plan work with assigned clients, medication pass, rounds, and documentation.
- Planned and led weekly breathwork, meditation, and psychoeducational focus groups built around simple practices residents could continue on their own.
- Planned and led community outings (e.g., a beach bonfire, local art exhibitions) from resident proposal through risk assessment and supervisor approval; drove and accompanied residents on standing program outings.

WorkED *June – July 2023*

Youth Program Lead - San Diego, CA - Full-time

- Designed and taught a three-week business and game-design curriculum for 20 middle schoolers from underrepresented backgrounds, ending in final projects built in Python, Canva, and Google Slides.

TEACHING, MENTORSHIP & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Teaching Assistant, PSYCH 20N: How Beliefs Create Reality *Spring 2026*

Stanford University | Instructor: Dr. Alia Crum

- Co-facilitated a weekly three-hour freshman seminar on how mindsets shape health, performance, and well-being; led small groups of 4–5 students and prepared class materials.

Research Mentor - *Stanford PsychSummer Program* *Summer 2024 & 2025*

- Mentored undergraduate researchers through the Stanford Undergraduate Psychology Association in project conceptualization, data management, and statistical analysis in R; some mentees continued in the lab.

Volunteer, Center for Creativity - *Redwood City, CA* *Sep 2026 – Present*

- Lead website and administrative-systems work for a volunteer-run community arts center and help run its events.
- Drafted a public comment for a Redwood City Council study session on the Stanford Medicine Cancer Center community-benefits framework, supporting inclusion of the arts.

Founder, 'Music for Mental Health' Fundraising Initiative - *Chico, CA* *July 2021 – Apr 2023*

- Founded a student-led live-music fundraiser at CSU, Chico that raised $5,000+ for NAMI Yolo County and the Boys & Girls Club of North Valley through annual events, including Sandypalooza; recruited student DJs, local businesses, venues, and nonprofit partners.

Volunteer Tutor, Project READ - *Redwood City Public Library* *Jan 2026 – Present*

- Meet weekly with an adult ESL learner on reading, writing, and conversation goals after completing multi-session tutor training.

Volunteer Science Educator, Brain Day - *Stanford Neuroscience Outreach* *Mar 2025 – Mar 2026*

- Led hands-on demonstrations with preserved human and animal brains in local middle-school classrooms alongside Stanford School of Medicine researchers.

Volunteer Vinyl DJ - *Stanford Jazz Workshop & local community events* *2025 – Present*

- Play vinyl sets at Redwood City cafes and community events and at the Stanford Jazz Festival.

GRANTS & FUNDED PROJECTS

Stanford Psychology Department Infrastructure Fund, EMBRACE Study (two awards, 2024–2025; $100,000 total). Contributed lab management, study coordination, and web design and development.

CONFERENCE POSTERS

Gasteiger, C., **Crena, A. D.**, Pagador, K., Jiang, T., Zion, S., Jo, B., Slavich, G. M., Spiegel, D., Steele, N., Berek, J. S., Shapira, L., & Crum, A. J. (2025, November). *Changing mindsets to improve whole-person health: A decentralized randomized trial of a novel digital intervention* [Poster session]. Joint Meeting of the Clinical Oncology Society of Australia and the International Psycho-Oncology Society, Adelaide, Australia.

SKILLS, CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Research operations: Clinical-trial coordination, recruitment and retention, informed consent, questionnaire administration, IRB amendments, SOP development, QA/QC, biospecimen logistics, RA training and supervision, participant scheduling, group-program logistics.

Data and software: Proficient in R, Microsoft Office, REDCap, Qualtrics, PHI-compliant file systems, Canva, Google Sheets, WordPress, SPSS; familiar with AFNI, UNIX, MATLAB, Python

Training: Stanford Human Subjects Protection; Good Clinical Practice for Social and Behavioral Research; HIPAA/PHI; Biosafety; Bloodborne Pathogens; MRI safety

Memberships: Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP); Association for Psychological Science (APS).